

HTML Basics

Part of **Web Development Foundations** · Estimated time: 35 min

Introduction

HTML gives a web page its structure — it's the skeleton everything else (CSS, JavaScript) hangs off of. Every element you place on a page, from a heading to an image, is an HTML tag, and the way tags nest inside one another forms a tree the browser reads to decide what to draw and in what order.

Core ideas

- Tags come in pairs that wrap content, like `<p>...</p>` for a paragraph or `<h1>...</h1>` for a top-level heading; a few, like `<img>` and `<br>`, are self-closing.
- Semantic elements — `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<article>`, `<footer>` — describe what a section of the page means, not just how it looks. Screen readers and search engines both rely on this meaning.
- Attributes add extra information to a tag: `href` on a link, `src` and `alt` on an image, `class` or `id` for styling and scripting hooks.
- Nesting tags inside each other builds the Document Object Model (DOM) — a tree structure that CSS and JavaScript both use to find and style specific parts of the page.

Example

```
<article>
  <h2>My First Post</h2>
  <p>Welcome to my <strong>new</strong> blog.</p>
  
</article>
```

Try it yourself

Build a single HTML file for a short personal bio: one `<h1>` with your name, a `<p>` introducing yourself, an `<img>` (any placeholder image URL works), and an `<a>` link to a site you like. Open it in a browser and check that everything appears in the order you expect.

Further reading

- [MDN — Learn HTML](https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn/HTML)

<https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn/HTML>

- [W3Schools — HTML Tutorial](https://www.w3schools.com/html/)

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